Minutes of the
General Government Committee
2020 Capital Budget & Long Range Capital Forecast Meeting
Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall
At 7:00 p.m. on December 2, 2019

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair - Councillor	R. Tyler Morin
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	A. Khan
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Tyler Morin called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Opening Comments

Sandra Serrao, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer, provided a brief presentation and overview of the Town's 2020 Capital Budget and 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast, the contents of the attached report, and the recommendations contained therein. S. Serrao discussed capital budget project categories, 2020 total capital budget allocation, funding sources, general levy allocations, capital reserve allocations, reserve contributions by source, spending cap recommendations, long-term and outstanding debt, federal gas tax revenues, multi-year projects, and highlights of the 2020 capital budget.

Councillor Tyler Morin, Budget Chair, thanked staff for their work and reviewed the contents of the proposed 2020 Capital Budget and 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast. Chair Tyler Morin noted that the 2020 Capital Budget and 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast reflects the strategic direction of Council and will effectively and strategically manage assets of the Town.

4. Opening Public Comments/Questions

Chair Tyler Morin noted that public comments and questions would be invited both before and after the committee's deliberations on the capital budget document. He opened the floor to public comments. There were no questions or comments from the public.

5. Review of Budget/Forecast

Chair Tyler Morin directed the committee through a section-by-section review of the capital budget and report.

5.1 2020 Capital Budget and 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast Report

Committee members asked questions regarding how assessment growth is forecast and sought examples of projects under the 'strategic initiatives' classification. S. Serrao noted that calculations are based on 0.75% assessment growth. Julie Mepham, Acting Manager of Budgets and Accounting, provided examples of strategic initiatives which could include projects such as master plans, environmental assessments, traffic calming, and capital projects from the strategic plan.

5.2 2020 Capital Budget and 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast Document

Questions and discussion focused on the following projects:

Studies and Other Initiatives

ENV001: Urban Forest Tree Canopy Technical Review
Committee Members asked questions about the timing of the project and inquired whether it was necessary to pursue in 2020. Catherine Bridgeman, Director of Operations & Environmental Services noted that the current plan is 10 years old and that updated data would help inform future strategic initiatives.

The Committee acknowledged that a number of studies are scheduled to be completed in the near future which will have unknown budget implications for implementation. Members asked whether studies listed in the 2020 Capital Budget could be pushed back to 2021. Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, noted that studies are prioritized and vetted by Senior Management and that Council may approve or defer such items.

Committee members requested information on the date a project was initiated in the budget process to be included on future capital project detail sheets in order to help determine the movement of projects through the budget forecast.

FIN002: Financial Sustainability Plan Update
Committee Members expressed interest in updating the Financial Sustainability Plan earlier in the term of Council.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That Project Number 'FIN002 Financial Sustainability Plan Update' be moved from the year 2021 of the Long Range Capital Forecast into the year 2020 of the capital budget.

CARRIED

ECD002: Economic Development Strategy Update
Committee Members asked whether a five year refresh of the strategy was required when the previous strategy was developed to cover ten years. Geoff Romanowski, Acting Director of Planning and Development Services, indicated that the five year update will

provide more relevant economic information on which to base future directions and priorities.

CAO002: Corporate Branding Update
Committee Members asked questions regarding the need to update the corporate brand and whether the project would include the Town's website. S. Baker noted that the last brand update occurred in 2005 and the community has changed over 15 years. He noted the desire to have a consistent look and feel across the town and the need to meet requirements of the *Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act*.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That Project Number 'CAO002: Corporate Branding Update' be moved from the 2020 capital budget to the year 2024 of the Long Range Capital Forecast to coincide with the 70th anniversary of the Town of Ajax.

CARRIED

ETP014: Automated Speed Enforcement
Committee members inquired whether community safety zones were a part of traffic calming. G. Romanowski noted that in order to have automated speed enforcement work effectively, community safety zones are required to put the infrastructure in place and sign appropriately. He noted that the project will look at areas for proposed community safety zones in more detail.

INF003: Acoustic Barriers & Entry Feature Condition Assessment
Committee members inquired about the age of existing acoustic barriers and whether there is a provincially managed timeline for assessment. C. Bridgeman noted that the initiative will review the age, structural condition and location of acoustic barriers and entry features and comply with Ontario regulatory requirements to have all core assets inventoried by 2021, and all others by 2023.

ETP010: Integrated Transportation Master Plan Update
Committee Members inquired why the timing of this project had been pushed back to 2024 in the 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast. G. Romanowski noted that it had originally been scheduled for 2021, however, a five-year review was recommended by the Development Charges Study Consultant. The update to the 2019 Integrated Transportation Master Plan (ITMP) will be used to inform the 2028 Development Charge Background Study.

CCD005: AJAX 3D Letters Public Art Installation
Committee members asked for clarification on the cost of the project. Tracey Vaughan, Director of Recreation, Culture & Community Development, indicated that the project cost also included installation and the infrastructure required for the letters. She noted that the letters are lit, and will be permanently installed and programmed at Pat Bayly Square.

CCD007: St. Francis Centre 10th Anniversary Public Art Installation
Committee members asked for clarification on the timing of the project. T. Vaughan noted the importance of celebrating the anniversary of the community arts and culture centre, and the opportunity for strategic streetscape branding to demonstrate the repurpose and use of the facility to the public.

Technology

ITS002: Migration to Office 365
Committee members asked questions regarding the migration to a cloud-based model, security, storage, and cost of implementation. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services / Town Clerk, indicated that the IT Strategic Plan consultants have recommended the cloud-based Office 365 over Microsoft 2019 licensed ownership, specifically for its storage and security benefits. Microsoft 2019 will be the last version available to purchase, making transition to a cloud-based subscription necessary. She noted that while the migration will be more expensive over time, it includes extra storage access.

ITS007: Workstation Replacement 2020
Committee Members asked for clarification regarding replacement across the organization. N. Cooper noted the shift towards purchasing mobile workstations, which are more expensive than desktop computers. She reviewed the selection review process to determine which job functions warrant replacement with a mobile workstation.

Town Buildings

BMT005: St. Francis Centre – Window Restoration & Roof Repl.
Committee Members asked questions regarding the need to move the project forward into the capital budget from the year 2023, and the impact the project will have on access to the facility. C. Bridgeman noted that damage is occurring on a regular basis. Restoration of the stained glass windows was never completed and the projects are being combined to minimize the impact to facility access, as both require the facility to be closed. She noted that the windows will need to be removed, however, all work will be undertaken onsite. The estimated duration of disruption is 6-8 weeks.

BMT033: Council Chambers AV & Interior Upgrades
Committee members asked questions regarding cost breakdown of the project, alternative options for live streaming, and emergency replacement of audio-visual equipment, if required. N. Cooper noted that the existing technology is 15 years old and failing frequently and is a critical component of the project. She noted that the project supports elements of the Council Strategic Plan. S. Serrao indicated that any emergency replacement would come out of the capital contingency reserve. Project costs over $100,000 would require Council approval. C. Bridgeman noted that if deferred, the cost of the project would likely increase.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That Project Number 'BMT033: Council Chambers AV & Interior Upgrades' be moved from the 2020 capital budget to the year 2021 of the Long Range Capital Forecast.

CARRIED

BMT030: Greenwood Pavilion – Flooring Replacement
Committee Members inquired about products that could be used to make interior finishes more sustainable. C. Bridgeman noted that resilient flooring is industry best practice and that replacement of the flooring is required due to safety hazards with the existing floor. She indicated that there is a schedule for interior finishes projects to determine priority.

BMT026: – Town Hall - Roof Repl./Bldg. Envelope Repairs - Construction
Committee members inquired whether the project could be undertaken in part. C. Bridgeman noted that the roof and cladding components are not recommended to be separated. She indicated that by bundling projects, the level of disruption to the facility is minimized.

BMT017: Town Hall - Interior Improvements
Committee members asked questions regarding the cost increase of the project and whether the project could be completed more efficiently with closure of the facility. C. Bridgeman explained how the project factored in work on evenings and weekends, as the building will remain occupied while the project is phased for completion. She noted that closure of the facility would require conversations with stakeholders but could be considered.

BMT035: Main Library – Roof Repl./Bldg. Envelope Repairs – Constr.
Committee members inquired about the cost increase of the project. C. Bridgeman noted that the 2019 consultant had provided updated costing through design.

Parking Lots

ENG002: Town Hall Campus Improvements - Design
Committee Members asked questions regarding the proposed timing with the forthcoming Recreation & Parks Master Plan, project components, impact to the existing gazebo, and safety concerns with the current parking lot design. C. Bridgeman noted the project is necessary based on the condition of the parking lot, however noted it could be deferred for a year. She indicated that it will also look to improve connectivity with a pathway, lighting and gazebo upgrades.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That Project Number 'ENG002: Town Hall Campus Improvements - Design' be moved from the 2020 capital budget to the year 2021 of the Long Range Capital Forecast.

CARRIED

ENG047: Bartlett Parking Lot Reconstruction
Committee Members asked for clarification on the cost of the project. C. Bridgeman indicated that the parking lot has reached the end of its lifecycle and the new design will incorporate permeable pavers.

Parks and Open Spaces

ENG015: Eagle Woods Parkette
ENG064: Daste North Parkette
ENG033: Fieldgate Homes Parkette
Committee Members inquired about the cost differential between parkette projects. C. Bridgeman noted that design is based on a park-by-park basis, taking into consideration the size of the park and whether the park is designed to be a parkette or larger community park.

ENV003: Parks Two Stream Waste/Recycling Containers – 2020
Committee Members asked for clarification on the two stream containers if the Town is looking into third party waste collection. C. Bridgeman indicated that the project will replace waste containers with two-stream recycling containers in the parks system. She noted that green waste is not collected in the parks system due to animal access and collection resource limitations.

Committee Members inquired why the project for Washroom Construction at Paradise Park was not included in the 2020 Capital Budget. C. Bridgeman noted that staff will be bringing forward a report to the Committee in January 2020 for review of alternate options. S. Serrao noted that the capital project remains open.

ENG018: Rotary Park Boardwalk - Construction
Committee Members asked questions regarding the impact of erosion and flooding hazards on the new bridge and funding source. C. Bridgeman noted that the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority (TRCA) is undertaking slope studies and that the bridge design has been approved by the TRCA. Stev Andis, Supervisor of Planning, Policy and Research, noted that that Town continues to work with the TRCA regarding erosion. S. Serrao indicated that this project is fully eligible for Gas Tax funding.

ENG019: St. Andrew's Improvements - Construction
Committee Members asked for clarification on the cost of the project, security considerations for the St. Andrew's Community Gardens, and whether the project should wait until the completion of the Recreation & Parks Master Plan. C. Bridgeman reviewed the components of the project, including proposed installation of a pickle ball court, improved lighting, and outdoor amenities discussed with the seniors' community. No security cameras are proposed at this time. T. Vaughan discussed membership to the Town's seniors clubs, noting that outdoor amenities are accessible to anyone, and indoor programs require membership. She noted that staff are aware that connection of the two buildings could be a potential future project in the area.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That Project Number 'ENG019: St. Andrew's Improvements – Construction' be moved from the 2020 capital budget to the year 2021 of the Long Range Capital Forecast.

CARRIED

ENG032: Denis O'Connor Park Retrofit
Committee Members inquired whether the playground will be relocated due to flooding. C. Bridgeman indicated that relocation would be examined.

ENG080: AAC – Tennis Court (south) Upgrades – Construction
Committee Members asked questions regarding timing of the project and whether other grant applications for the Ajax Community Centre campus will impact the location. C. Bridgeman noted that in consultation with stakeholders summer was identified as the most appropriate time to take the courts offline temporarily. She indicated that outcomes of the grant application will not be known until 2021.

ENG051: Soccer Post Replacement
Committee Members inquired whether the project could wait until the needs for soccer fields could be determined through the Recreation & Parks Master Plan, and whether inclusion of a project to install two batting cages at Cedar Park and Hermitage Park could be considered. S. Serrao and J. Mepham discussed challenges with including a new project in the budget for approval without having appropriate costing. C. Bridgeman noted that the project as proposed would cover replacement of all posts across the Town.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That Project Number 'ENG051: Soccer Post Replacement' be reduced from $60,000 to $30,000.

CARRIED

Road Networks

ETP015: Traffic Calming on Town Roads - 2020
Committee Members asked questions regarding the reduced cost, whether all projects listed for 2019 had been completed, and the transparency of changes in the policy to identify roads to implement traffic calming. G. Romanowski noted that all 2019 traffic calming projects had been put on hold until the Town's Traffic Calming Warrant process is updated, to be completed in early 2020. Once updated, design for all 2019 and 2020 projects will be completed in 2020. He indicated that projects will no longer be listed annually for completion in order to allow staff the opportunity to better allocate and prioritize project needs with the available budget. John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, noted that new traffic calming measures such as bollards are more cost-effective, allowing for implementation of traffic calming on more roads. He indicated that a public open house will be held to inform residents of the new warrant process and that a report will come to the Committee for approval before changes are implemented.

ETP001: Westney/Millington Signal - Construction
Committee Members asked for clarification on the change in cost for the project. J. Grieve noted that the Region of Durham is near completion of design and as a result, costs were reduced.

ENG039: Traffic Signals Rossland Road and Riverside Drive - Construction
Committee Members asked about the cost increase of the project. J. Grieve provided rationale for the increase.

Committee Members inquired further about the status of Range Road and the project's movement through the capital budget and long range forecast. C. Bridgeman noted that staff will look at costing once the Region has determined timing for watermain replacement. J. Mepham indicated that the project was approved for the year 2018 and will likely increase in cost when it comes forward.

ENG036: Rossland Road Widening – Church to Westney - Construction
Committee Members inquired why the project is proposed to be moved to years 2021-2022, with costs increasing. Rick Chalmers, Supervisor of Infrastructure & Asset Management provided a rationale, noting conflict with Regional projects.

6. Closing Public Comments/Questions

Chair Tyler Morin invited public comments and questions prior to the Committee's final consideration and approval of the 2020 capital budget and 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast.

Chris Baker, Ajax resident, asked if sidewalk repairs are included in the capital budget, opportunities for cost-sharing with the Region on project numbers 'ENG045: Rossland Road Detailed Design - Westney to Lake Ridge' and 'ENG046: Rossland Road Widening - Church to Westney – Construction', the planning rationale for project number 'ETP001 – Westney/Millington Signal - Construction' and the election budget allocation in the General Levy Funded Reserve. C. Bridgeman noted that sidewalk repair is captured in the Operations & Environmental Services Operating Budget. Mayor Collier shared information on the Regional Road Rationalization Study, noting that Rossland Road meets the requirements to be a regional road and that there would not be cost sharing with those projects. G. Romanowski indicated that with new planning practices being stricter on traffic flow, the situation requiring retrofit will likely not occur again in the future. N. Cooper shared information regarding components of the municipal election budget and noted that candidate costs are funded by the candidate.

There were no further comments or questions from the public.

The Committee recessed at 9:45 p.m.

The Committee resumed the meeting at 9:50 p.m.

7. Budget Recommendation

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the 2020 Capital Budget and 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast be approved, as amended.

2. That the following 2020 General Levy Funded Reserve Allocation be approved:

Reserve	Amount
Veh./Eqp. Replacement	$1,657,900
Roads Maintenance	1,628,200
General Infrastructure	921,600
Building Maintenance	801,100
Strategic Initiatives	387,000
Development	200,000
Post Growth	71,400
Election	69,000
Total	**$5,736,200**

3. That Council approve the deviations below from the Financial Sustainability Plan Spending Caps for the following reserves in 2020, as amended:

Reserve	Deviation
Building Maintenance	$1,327,800
Veh./Eqp. Replacement	915,000
Strategic Initiatives	0
Total	**$2,242,800**

CARRIED

Recorded Vote:

In Favour: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Mayor Collier, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Khan, Regional Councillor Lee, Chair Tyler Morin

Opposed: None

Chair Tyler Morin and members of the committee thanked staff for their work on the capital budget and thanked residents for their comments and questions.

8. Adjournment (9:53 p.m.)

Moved by: A. Khan

That the December 2, 2019 meeting of the General Government Committee 2020 Capital Budget & 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast, be adjourned.

CARRIED

Chair

D-Clerk